

Executive Interview Thesis

Build the company to carry the promise.

THE ACTUAL WORK

Convert founder-led demand into a professional-services operating system that reliably sells, staffs, delivers, proves, renews, and learns — with humans and AI agents managed as one accountable capacity model.

Central contradiction

Remain bespoke enough to produce consequential client outcomes while becoming repeatable enough to forecast, staff, price, improve, and scale.

Operating partner posture

Success appears in retained clients, controlled margin, credible forecasts, stronger managers, dependable agent systems, and fewer routine founder escalations.

Economic lens

Utilization, realization, scope change, staffing mix, agent cost, delivery variance, renewal, margin, cash conversion, and bench readiness must reconcile as one story.

Change burden

Document enough of the work to price, transfer, evaluate, and improve it — without creating bureaucracy that outruns client value.

FIRST-YEAR OPERATING SCORECARD

Client retention

Outcome acceptance · executive sponsor confidence · renewal probability · reference readiness

Delivery integrity

Milestone variance · utilization · realization · change requests · escalation aging · rework

Forecast credibility

Stage conversion · handoff quality · booked-to-bill · forecast-to-actual · capacity coverage

Founder leverage

Founder escalations · attention hours · decision latency · reopened decisions · exception recurrence

Agent capacity

Task success · human override · evaluation pass rate · exception rate · latency · unit cost

Bench and onboarding

Time-to-productivity · skills coverage · pipeline-weighted demand · utilization floor · hiring lead time

Promise Compiler

Six operating contracts turn a raw commitment into executable work.

01 · Commitment contract

Translate discovery and proposal language into a measurable client outcome, named decision owner, explicit assumptions, and acceptance evidence.

02 · Scope contract

Bound included work, exclusions, client obligations, dependencies, change-control triggers, pricing logic, and margin sensitivity.

03 · Capacity contract

Match pipeline confidence to the human-and-agent mix, seniority, utilization, ramp time, evaluation burden, and contingency capacity.

04 · Execution contract

Expose schedule, scope, quality, adoption, client-readiness, and escalation risk through a weekly operating record with one accountable owner.

05 · Evidence contract

Define what the client must be able to point to: operating result, user behavior, capability transfer, risk reduction, or financial outcome.

06 · Renewal contract

Return actual delivery data to pricing, proposals, staffing, sales coaching, onboarding, playbooks, and agent improvement.

The compiler does not make a promise “standard.” It makes assumptions, ownership, economics, authority, evidence, and renewal logic explicit enough to operate.

Executive Conversation

Questions that test the mandate before prescribing the mechanism.

- Where is founder involvement currently value-creating, and where is it compensating for an absent mechanism?
- Which client outcome most reliably predicts renewal, and who signs that it was achieved?
- Where do proposal assumptions most often break during delivery?
- What is the current unit of capacity: person, role, pod, workflow, agent, or a blended model?
- Which utilization or margin number is trusted least, and what data conflict causes the distrust?
- What can a salesperson promise without delivery review? What should require one?
- Which AI agent would the team miss tomorrow, and which creates more confidence than evidence?
- What decision should the COO own independently in the first month?

EVIDENCE I WOULD BRING INTO THE ROOM

I am strongest where a company needs operating discipline and enough technical fluency to make AI part of the work without mistaking automation for accountability.

Vape-Jet

AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, support, systems, telemetry, and roughly 1,000 fielded robots.

DudeWorth

Hands-on agentic workflow, evaluation, human-authority, governance, adoption, and value design.

Amazon

24/7 distributed operating mechanisms protecting a high-velocity customer promise.

Compunetics

Engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer, and high-reliability program integration.

OPERATING SYSTEM STAKEHOLDERS

- Founder / CEO — market signal, external demand, strategic exceptions
- COO — operating truth, economics, capacity, decision rights, cadence
- Sales — promise quality, assumptions, stage integrity, handoff
- Delivery leaders — staffing, execution, evidence, escalation, renewal
- Finance — forecast, margin, billing, cash, scenario visibility
- Agent owners — job definition, evaluation, human authority, unit cost

Independent candidate work. MDC Executive Search is the recruiting channel; the hiring company was not identified in the public posting.